

Why learn to spell?

SPELLING IS IMPORTANT FOR BOTH READING AND WRITING.

Rules can help with spelling; however, there are many exceptions to these rules, which can sometimes make spelling difficult. Learning to spell well is worth the effort, since it helps a writer convey meaning clearly.

Letters

There are twenty-six letters in the English alphabet, which can be written as lowercase or capital letters. These letters also make specific sounds, with some making more than one sound. In special cases, two letters—such as *c* and *h*—combine to produce one unique sound different from any individual letter sound, such as *ch* in *change*. Understanding when to use lowercase and capital letters helps improve spelling, and better spelling increases the overall quality of writing.

The word *alphabet* comes from the **first two letters** of the **Greek** alphabet: *alpha* and *beta*.



These lowercase letters representing the whole alphabet are arranged in alphabetical order.

The QWERTY keyboard—named after the first six letters and arranged in capital letters—was put in this order so that the most common letters were not close together, thereby avoiding mistakes that caused jams in early typewriters.

